

R3.12. Giving a technical talk



**"Would you like the technical or
the nontechnical presentation?"**

Instructions for the test

During your professional life it is very likely that you will be required at some stage to make a presentation on a technical theme. In a multilingual or international context, your presentation would have to be in English. During this sequence, you will practise researching, organising and presenting technical material in English to a small audience.

Task Requirements:

15-minute presentation in pairs – including questions, using ppt slides. No notes allowed.

Topic: present the chapter you are given on week 49. You may do some extra research in order to get a better understanding of the topic. Make sure to include a quiz or questions, an exercise to test your audience's understanding. This will be followed by questions.

Your presentations should include the following elements:

- A dynamic introduction and a clear plan
- present your topic – link with previous chapters
- explain the principles using examples (lines of code) and diagrams
- a proper conclusion, with the main points of your talk
- bibliography
- quiz/ questions/ exercise

The fundamental point of this presentation is that the audience should have learnt something new and should be convinced to keep learning.

<u>Assessment criteria:</u>	
Content and structure • Technical terms definitions • Use of visuals/ graphs • level of written detail • structure, connection between points • Use of rhetorical questions • interaction with audience • quality of technical demonstration	Presentation skills • Clarity • Fluidity • freedom from notes • Comprehensibility/ pronunciation • Enthusiasm • contact with audience • Body language • Voice (volume, tone, speed)

Creating an interesting and informative introduction

OK, let's get started.

Hi/ good morning everyone. We're going to present...

Today, we're going to talk about...

Did you know that..? Have you ever...?

But before going into details about.. let's have a look at

But (main question)

To answer these questions, I'll begin by talking about

Then Bob will say a word about

Finally we'll go over

Our talk will take about 10 minutes

If you have any questions, please feel free to interrupt as we go along

We'll be happy to take any question you may have at the end of our talk

Right then. Let's start with our first point which is

Tips for explaining technical material in layman's terms

- ✓ Define all technical terms in everyday language, don't use jargon
- ✓ Put things in context, say what they are used for
- ✓ If you use abbreviations, explain what they stand for and what they mean
- ✓ Give examples, analogies and comparisons from everyday life

Useful language:

- A USB key **refers to** an object which **is used to** save data.
- It is for **saving** data (sert à)
- A USB key **allows you to** save data (vous permet de).
- It **acts** as...
- For example/ for instance...
- It's as if (c'est comme si)
- FBI **stands for** Federal Bureau of Investigation.

Framework/ class/ IP vs mac address/ CSS/ Git/ Java/ API/ library/ OOP/ CoPilot

Answer the following questions to prepare your definition:

- What is it?

- What is it for?

- How does it work?

- What is it similar to or different from (based on the audience's knowledge)?

- Give examples

The passive voice

BE + Past participle (+ BY + agent)

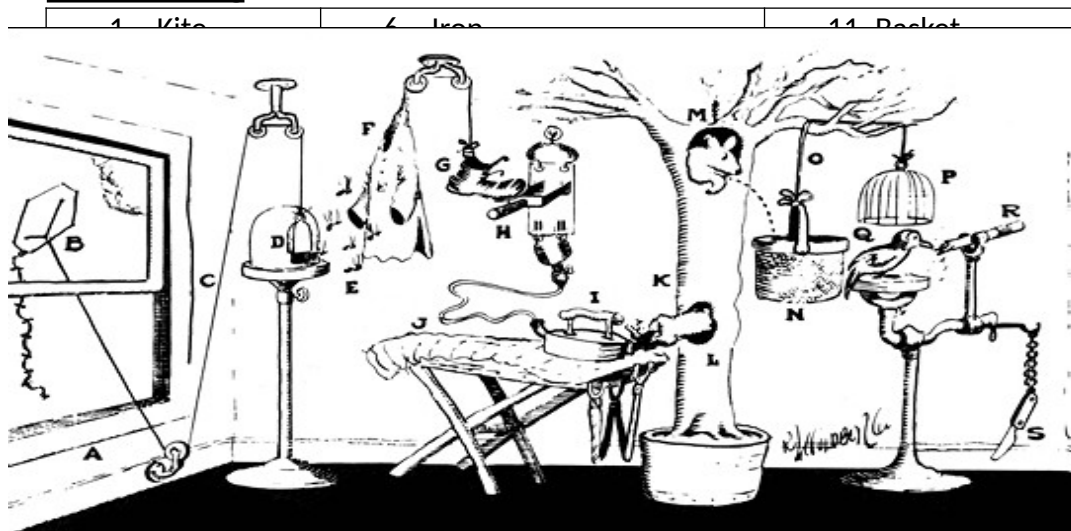
BE is conjugated in various tenses:

- is called
- is being called
- have been called
- was called
- was being called
- will be called
- would be called
- would have been called
- being called

The passive is used when:

- we don't know who performed the action (ex: My car has been stolen)
- can be the equivalent of 'on' in French (ex: on m'a volé ma voiture= My car has been stolen)
- it is really obvious who performed the action (ex: A man was arrested)
- **we are not interested in who performed the action, only the result or the process itself**

Rube Goldberg



Fill in the gaps:
1. First, the window
.....

(open) by the kite, lifting a small door and liberating moths.

2. Then, the moths start eating the red flannel shirt. Once the shirt (eat), the shoe ... (step) on a switch and the iron (turn on).

3. Once the iron ... (start burning) through the ironing board, the smoke enters the hole in the tree, pushing the opossum out.

4. Once the opossum (jump) into the basket, the cage..... (lift) and the woodpecker (set free).

5. Finally, the pen(sharpen) by the woodpecker.

6. A pocketknife ... (hang) at the end of the stick, in case the opossum gets sick.

Fill in the gaps:

1. Loops let our code run the same block over and over again until the condition (satisfy).

2. Every method (make up) of statements.
3. Once a value (assign) to your variable, that value can change.
4. This line should(highlight) in red.

Rewrite the following sentences in the passive voice:

1. He codes the program in C#.
2. They have drawn the specification requirements.
3. Once they have read the documentation, they have developed the application.
4. "Catch blocks" can catch and handle exceptions.
5. Once the programmer has added a new functionality, he will test it.
6. As soon as the developers had tested the solution, they presented it to the client.

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Describing how something works

1. Follow the timeline and highlight steps using link words.

***Once** the instruction register has been decoded, the program counter is updated to address the next instruction.*

***Before** installing the system, the technician has to test it.*

***Prior to** installing the system, the technician must test it.*

***After** the system has been tested, it can be installed.*

***When** a collision occurs, it will be detected by the computers that are transmitting.*

***When** the operating system comes to the end of the buffer, it **reads** the next block.*

***As soon as** you finish replacing the statements, Visual Studio **will** draw a red squiggly underline beneath your method call.*

Then/ Also first/ secondly/ finally

NB : After *when*, *as soon as* and *until*, the future tense cannot be used (*will*). Culturally speaking, English cannot think of using the same tense for 2 consecutive events. So the present tense is used for the first chronological event, and *will* or the present tense for the following event.

1. Use some passive structures- it allows you to put the important piece of information first, while stressing the process.

*IP addresses **are allocated by** the DHCP server.*

*If the network **is heavily loaded**, there will be many collisions and the performance will deteriorate.*

Data are transmitted in small chunks called packets.

2. Don't forget to engage with your audience:

As you can see in the first line

Let's have a closer look at these 2 lines

I'd like to draw your attention to the top right-hand corner of this graph

"How potato chips are made": Watch the video and take notes to describe the process:

Giving instructions

Describe instructions using link words and in full sentences.

Ex: How to declare a function in Kotlin:

- **In order to** create your own function, use the *fun* keyword, and write the name of the function, followed by parentheses ():
- **Once** the function has been created/ you have created your function, you can **then** execute it by calling it.
- To call a function in Kotlin, write the name of the function followed by two parentheses ().

1. How to return a value in Kotlin

2. How to add single line comments

3. How to create a variable and assign it a value in Kotlin

Avoiding death by power point

Watch the video and note down the tips

Relative pronouns: WHO, WHICH, THAT (« QUI/ QUE »)

Subject	Object
who	who/ whom
which	which
that	that

1. They are mostly used as **subjects**

- **WHO** refers to a person
- **WHICH** refers to a thing
- **THAT** refers to people or things

Ex: The developer who wrote this program is experienced (who replaces “the developer”, and “the developer” is the subject of the verb “wrote”).

Ex: He came up with an idea which changed the world (which replaces “an idea”, and “an idea” is the subject of the verb “changed”).

2. **WHOM, WHICH and THAT** can be used as **objects**. When they are direct objects (answer the question “what”), then the pronouns are generally implied and do not appear.

WHO is sometimes used instead of WHOM in informal English

Ex: The client I met yesterday works in retail. (you could say= the client whom I met)

Ex: The application you developed runs smoothly. (the application which you developed)

3. **WHO** and **WHICH** are often replaced by **THAT** in American English, and especially in informal English.

Ex: The developer that wrote this program is experienced/ an idea that changed the world

THAT (as a subject) is almost always used after everything, anything, nothing, something,

only, all and superlatives. *Ex: everything that moves/ something that will surprise you/ the only thing that matters/ the most fantastic news*

4. When the information is in between commas, **WHICH** or **WHO** must be used, **THAT** cannot be used.

Ex: The woman who/that just came in works here. ("who just came in" is essential to the sentence).

Ex: The woman, who just came in, works here. ("who just came in" is only additional information).

A Listening exercise : Listen and circle the correct phonetic symbol

a/ decrease	[I]	[i:]	[aI]	g/ diagnostic	[I]	[i:]	[aI]
	[I]	[i:]	[aI]		[I]	[i:]	[aI]
b/ device	[I]	[i:]	[aI]	h/ antistatic	[I]	[i:]	[aI]
	[I]	[i:]	[aI]		[I]	[i:]	[aI]
c/ widespread	[I]	[i:]	[aI]	i/ message	[I]	[i:]	[aI]
d/ business	[I]	[i:]	[aI]	j/ routine	[I]	[i:]	[aI]
e/ analyse	[I]	[i:]	[aI]	k/ language	[I]	[i:]	[aI]
f/ predefine	[I]	[i:]	[aI]	l/ release	[I]	[i:]	[aI]
	[I]	[i:]	[aI]		[I]	[i:]	[aI]
	[I]	[i:]	[aI]				

B Now see if your partner knows which sound you are making. Say one of the words in the chart, and see if he/she picks the correct one

1.	a / fill	b / feel	c / file	7.	a / live	b / leave	c / live
2.	a / fit	b / feat	c / fight	8.	a / sit	b / seat	c / site
3.	a / unit		c / unite	9.	a / list	b / least	
4.	a / hip	b / heap	c / hype	10.		b / delete	c / delight
5.	a / chip	b / cheap		11.	a / rid	b / read	c / ride
6.	a / lick	b / leak	c / like	12.	a / bit	b / beat	c / byte

C Look at the expressions and try to say which of the three vowel sounds they contain.

Write in the correct phonetic symbol

English teachers	Italian ice-cream
Greek Islands	Indian tea
Swiss cheese	Swedish films
Irish whiskey	Egyptian spices

D Rules to help predict the pronunciation:

<u> </u> I	i:	aI
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E Now fill in the following table with the words underneath:

l	i:	al

feature	develop	initialize	semi-conductor
pin	reset	bit stream	microphone
compiler	diagram	assign	receiver
file	iterate	minute	site
multiplexed	analysis	delete	signal
circuit			

Title and subject

Today, we'd like to speak about
The topic of today's presentation is

Objective

The objective of the presentation is to

Our aim today is to

Main parts/outline

We've divided our talk into four main parts
Firstly, what we want to do is talk about
Secondly, we will look at

Then/ after that/ finally, Tom will speak about

Timing

The presentation will take about 10 min

Questions

If you have any questions, please feel free to interrupt

We'll be glad to take any question at the end of our presentation

Link to start

OK. Let's start with the first point which is Right. We can begin by looking at

Signalling – linking the parts

Sequencing ideas

Firstly/ secondly/ then/ next/ finally
The first/ second/ final point

Ending a section

That's all I wanted to say about
I think that covers everything on

Intermediate questions

Are there any questions or comments on that?

Opening a new section

Let's now look at
Now I want to turn to
This brings me to the third and final point which is

Exploring a list of points

Regarding / Concerning / With respect to

Adding ideas

In addition to this/ Moreover
However (cependant)/ despite (malgré)

So/ therefore

Highlighting and emphasizing

I'd like to emphasize (mettre l'accent sur)
I'd like to stress (souligner)
It is essential to understand that

Rhetorical questions

So, how does this work?

Creating rapport

I'm sure you're thinking that
Did you know that
As we've already seen in previous chapters

Visual aids

Introducing the visual

OK. Let's take a look at these lines
These lines illustrate/ demonstrate
This is a graph which shows
Here we can see / As you can see

Focusing attention

I'd like to draw your attention to
One of the most important aspects is

Closing a presentation

Signalling the end

OK. That brings us to the end of our talk
Right, that covers everything we wanted to say about

Concluding

To conclude, we'd like to say
In conclusion

Closing

Thank you for your attention/ listening

Inviting questions

Are there any questions?
We'd be glad to take any questions